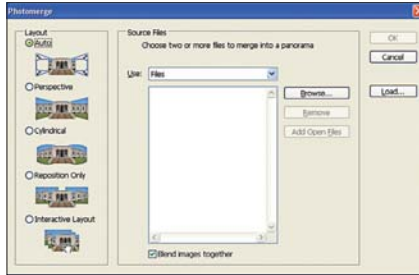




Panoramic Photography

Panoramic shots no longer require you to use a tripod and take multiple shots with the utmost care. Photo editing software now can align and then stitch up multiple images together to create a panoramic photo. To create one, zoom out as much as you can so you get the best wide-angle view possible. Stand in one place and take multiple shots one after the other while keeping in mind some line of reference in that view. Capture the next shot with that line of reference in the view.



Making panorama images

Copy the photos to your computer. Start Photoshop CS3. Go to File > Automate > Photomerge. Select the photos you took for the panorama and choose the Auto layout. Click OK and give Photoshop some time to stitch the images together. The end image might be very large, so you might want to resize it down.



Using The Self-timer To Avoid Camera Shake

Tripods aren't at times sufficient to stop shake. Some of the movement that occurs is when the shoot button is pressed. Even the slightest movement to the camera can ruin a photo. So even if you do use a tripod, it's best to use a timer of maybe 2 or 10 seconds to be on the safe side.



Using Slow Sync Flash

Slow Sync is a function found on some cameras, which allows the camera to use a longer shutter speed and a flash. Normally, the shutter speed of the camera is set to be really fast to match the flash, which only lasts for a fraction of a second. In such cases, the foreground object ends up very bright and the surroundings completely dark. Slow Sync flash is usually good for better exposure (but can cause motion blur due to the long shutter speeds). The result is a well-illuminated photo, with the surroundings turning out fairly bright.



Good Portrait Photographs

Taking portrait photographs is an art in itself. First, you need to have a good subject. Cloudy skies have a soft

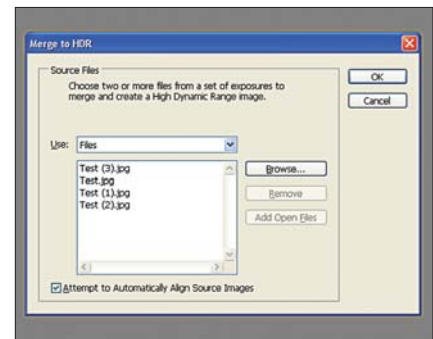
light but and are bright enough at the same time to get good photos with soft shadows. The portrait mode that is built into your camera might not always be the best way to get great portrait photographs. Try and zoom into the subject and, if possible, select a larger aperture. While focusing, try to leave a lot of the background along with the subject. The subject should preferably be on one side of the image.



Using Shutter And Aperture Priority Modes

Some of the cameras we use have certain semi-automatic modes called shutter priority and aperture priority, which allow you to set a fixed aperture size or shutter speed and the camera to handle the rest of the settings such as ISO.

Use the aperture size to your advantage wherever possible. For example, if you are in a well-lit-up area and a fast-action photograph is to be taken, select a fast shutter speed such as 1/1000th or 1/2000th of a second. Similarly, if you have a low-light



Making your own HDR photos

ratings, then manually set aperture and shutter speeds to simulate different exposure values.

There are some things that need to be taken care of. All the photos need to be taken without the camera moving, or any movement in the surroundings, so the use of a tripod is highly recommended here. Some cameras have the option to be able to take photos in quick succession at different exposure values which works like the Burst

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situation, select a large aperture size such as F2.8 or F4.



HDR Photography

HDR (High Definition Range) Photography has just only started picking up. Surprising, because pretty much anybody can create HDR photos without too much of a problem. In short, you require photos to be taken at multiple exposures. To do this, look at the EV (Exposure Value) rating on the camera. You need three photos at least—one taken at 0 EV, one with a positive EV, and one with the same negative value. You can always use many more images if needed. If your camera doesn't allow you to change EV

mode. Use this feature if your camera supports it.

When you have the photos ready, use Photoshop CS2 or Photoshop CS3. Go to File > Automate > Merge to HDR. Add the photos you've taken and click OK. Photoshop will create a HDR photo for you which can be further tweaked.

Another commercial software for creating HDR images is Photomatix (www.hdrsoft.com). A free open source software called Qtpfsgui is also available. It can be downloaded from <http://qtpfsgui.sourceforge.net>. An additional set of files may be required for Qtpfsgui to run; the files are available on the download page.